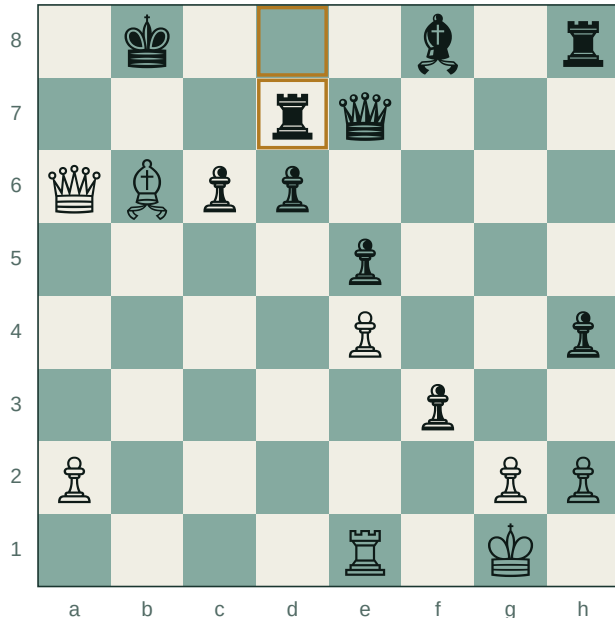


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 29

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 28...Rd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

29. Rb1 Rb7 30. Ba7+ Kc8 31. Qxc6+ Qc7 32. Qe8+

29.Rb1 The rook moves from e1 to b1. Recorded reply: **29...Rb7**.

30.Ba7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on b1 attacks the rook on b7. Recorded reply: **30...Kc8**.

31.Qxc6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From c6 it attacks king on c8 and rook on b7. Recorded reply: **31...Qc7**.

32.Qe8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e8 it attacks king on c8 and bishop on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -6 to -5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on b8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8. Check for tactical protection.